

GitHub Copilot CLI Quick Reference

Global Shortcuts

Key	Action
@ FILE	Attach file context
# NUM	Attach Issue/PR context
! CMD	Run local shell command
?	Quick help
Esc / Esc Esc	Cancel / Rewind
Ctrl+C / D	Cancel Clear / Shutdown
Ctrl+G / L	Editor / Clear screen
Ctrl+Ent / Q	Queue message (busy)
Ctrl+R	Search history
Ctrl+X /	Run slash command typing
Ctrl+X o	Open last timeline link
Shift+Ent	Insert newline
Shift+Tab	Cycle Modes (Std/Pln/Auto)

Navigation & Timeline

Key	Action
Ctrl+O / E / T	Expand items / Reasoning
PgUp / Dn	Scroll timeline view
Ctrl+A / E	Cursor Home / End
Ctrl+K / U	Clear End / Start
Tab / Ctrl+Y	Accept inline completion

Config Directory (~/.copilot)

Path	Description
settings.json	Personal user settings
config.json	Managed application state
mcp-config.json	User MCP definitions
lsp-config.json	User LSP definitions
agents/ skills/	Custom agents / skills
hooks/	User-level hook scripts
copilot-inst.md	Global custom instructions

Slash Commands

Command	Action
/add-dir	Allow directory access
/clear /new	Start new session
/compact	Summarize history
/diff	Review local changes
/help /init	Help / Setup Instructions
/model /plan	Select model / Implement plan
/research	Deep research (Web/Repo)
/share	Export to MD/HTML/Gist
/undo /tasks	Rewind turn / Tasks
/user /usage	Manage user / Session stats

IDE & Chat Context

Type	Variable / Shortcut
Inline Trigger	Alt + \ (Win) Opt + \ (Mac)
Inline Cycle	Alt +] / [Opt +] / [
Chat Variables	#block, #file, #selection, #sym
Chat Experts	@azure, @github, @vscode, @workspace

Modes & Permissions

Mode / Key	Effect / Response
Std / Plan / Auto	Interactive / Design / Auto
y / n	Allow / Deny specific request
! / #	Always Allow / Deny this session
?	Show detailed request info

Tip: copilot completion <shell> to enable tab completion.

Terminal Tab Management

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + Shift + T	Open a new profile tab.
Ctrl + Shift + Number (1-9)	Open a new tab using a specific profile index.
Ctrl + Alt + Number (1-9)	Switch directly to a specific tab index.
Ctrl + Tab	Switch to the next tab.
Ctrl + Shift + Tab	Switch to the previous tab.
Ctrl + Shift + D	Duplicate the current tab.
Ctrl + Shift + W	Close the current tab.

Terminal Pane Management

Shortcut	Action
Alt + Shift + Plus	Split the current pane vertically.
Alt + Shift + Minus	Split the current pane horizontally.
Alt + Shift + D	Duplicate the current pane.
Alt + Arrow Keys	Move focus between panes.
Alt + Shift + Arrow	Resize the current pane.

Window and Global Shortcuts

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + Shift + N	Start a new Windows Terminal window.
Win + '	Summon Quake mode (toggle terminal visibility).
F11 or Alt + Enter	Toggle full-screen mode.
Ctrl + ,	Open the Settings UI.
Ctrl + Alt + ,	Open the defaults.json settings file.
Ctrl + Shift + P	Open the Command Palette.
Ctrl + C / Ctrl + V	Copy and paste selected text.
Alt + F4	Close the entire Windows Terminal window.